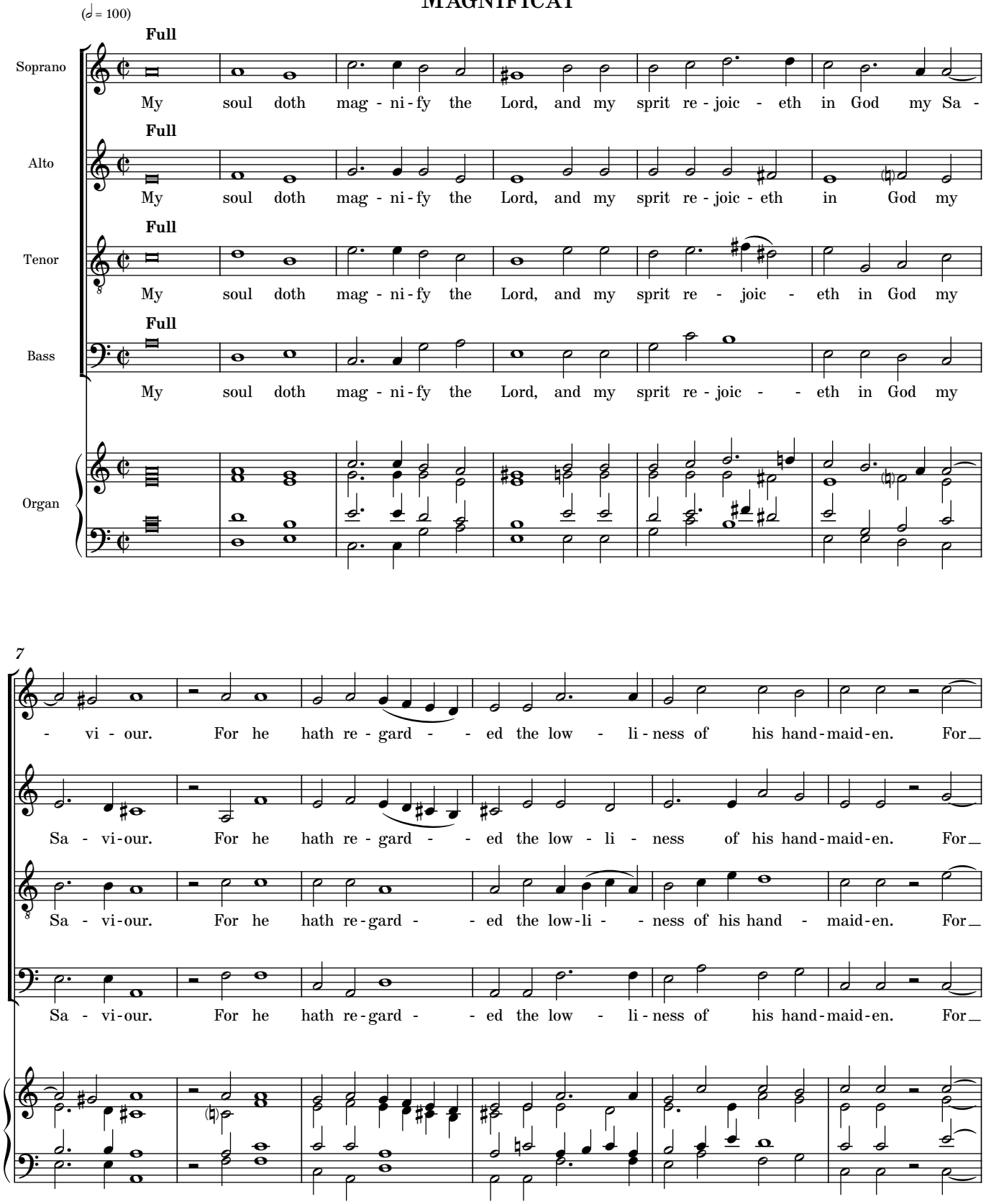ANCIENT GROOVE MUSIC

'High' Evening Service
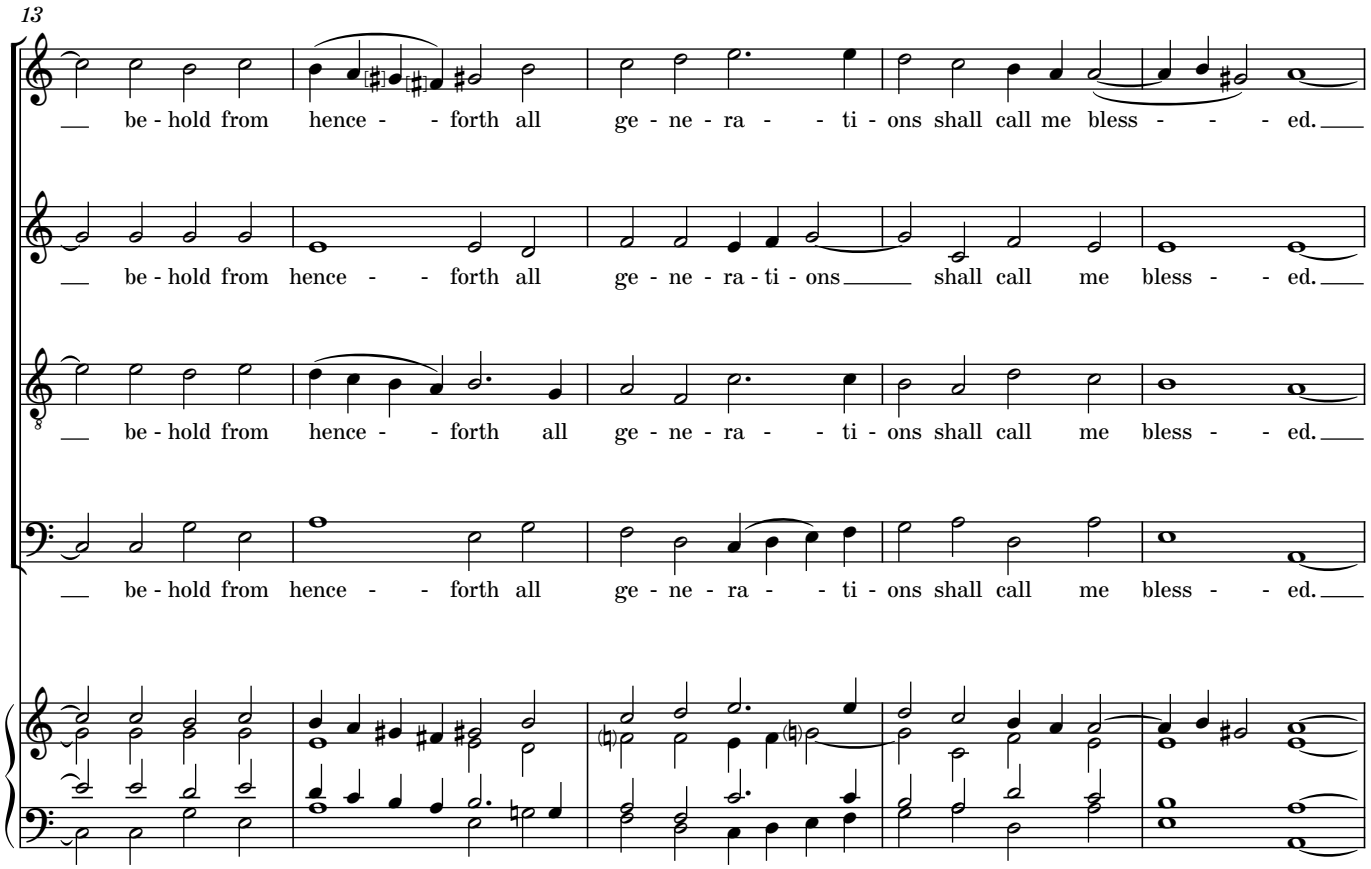
Edited by
Ben Byram-Wigfield

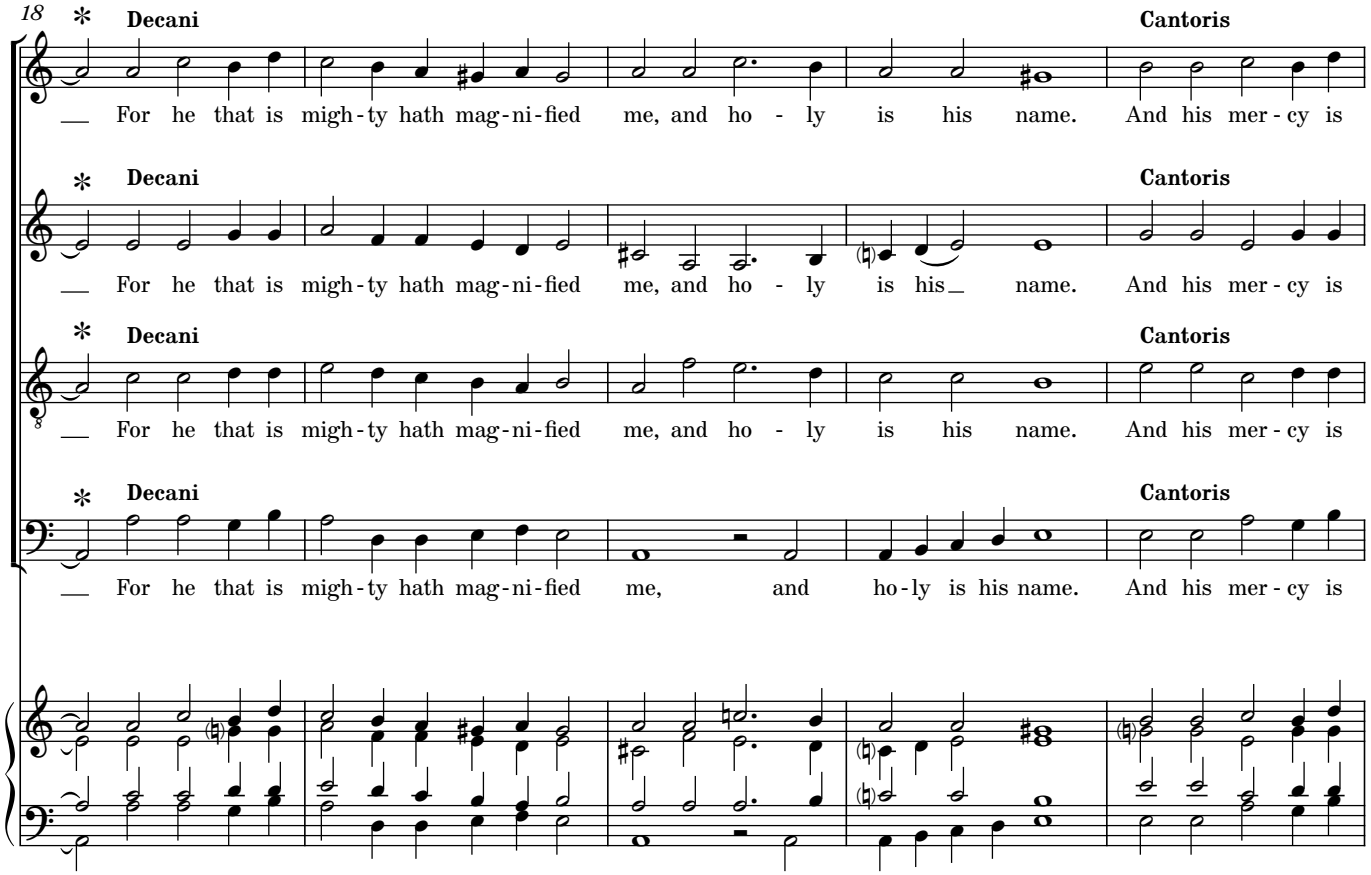
RICHARD FARRANT
(c.1525 - 1580)

Magnificat
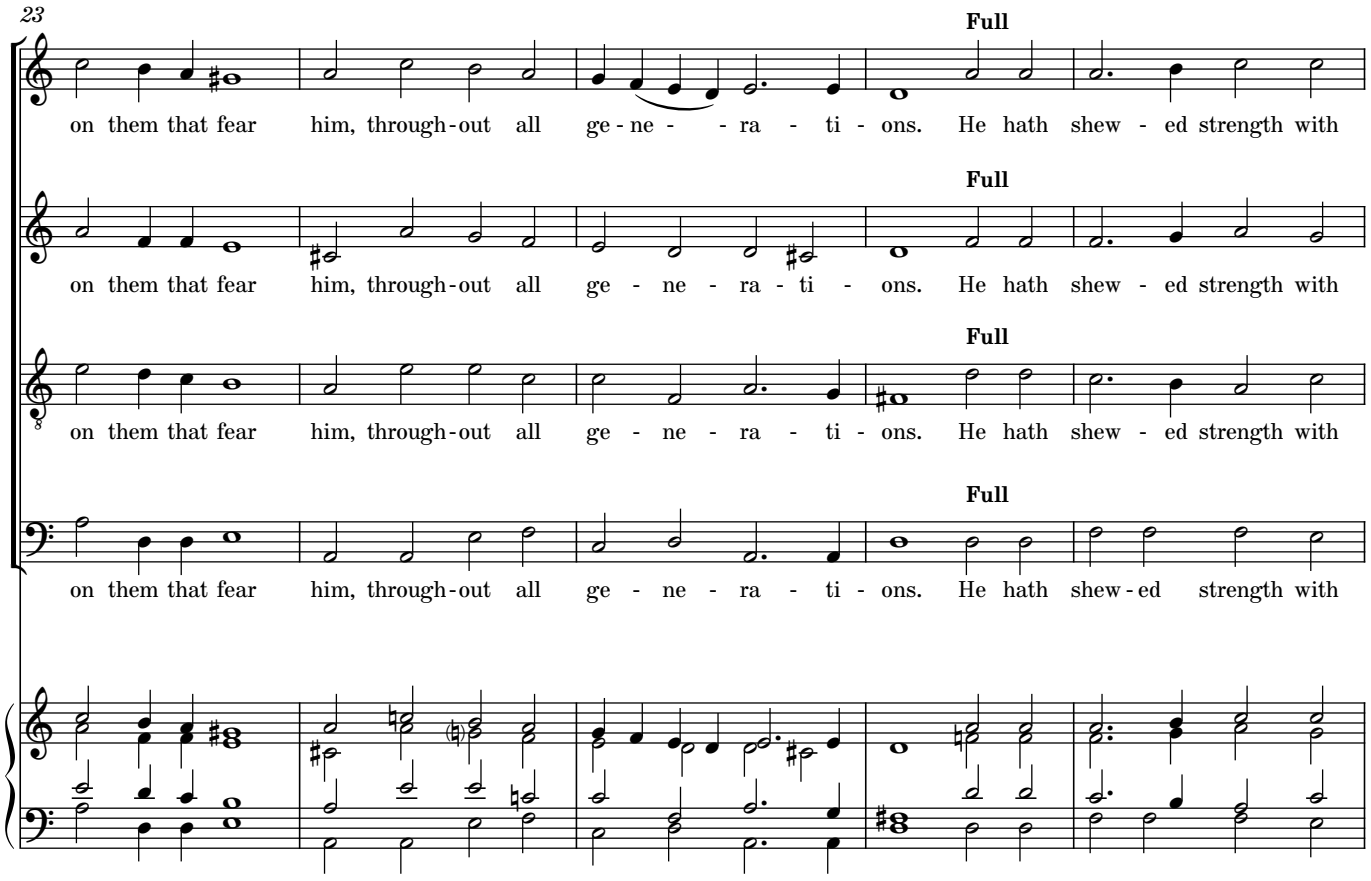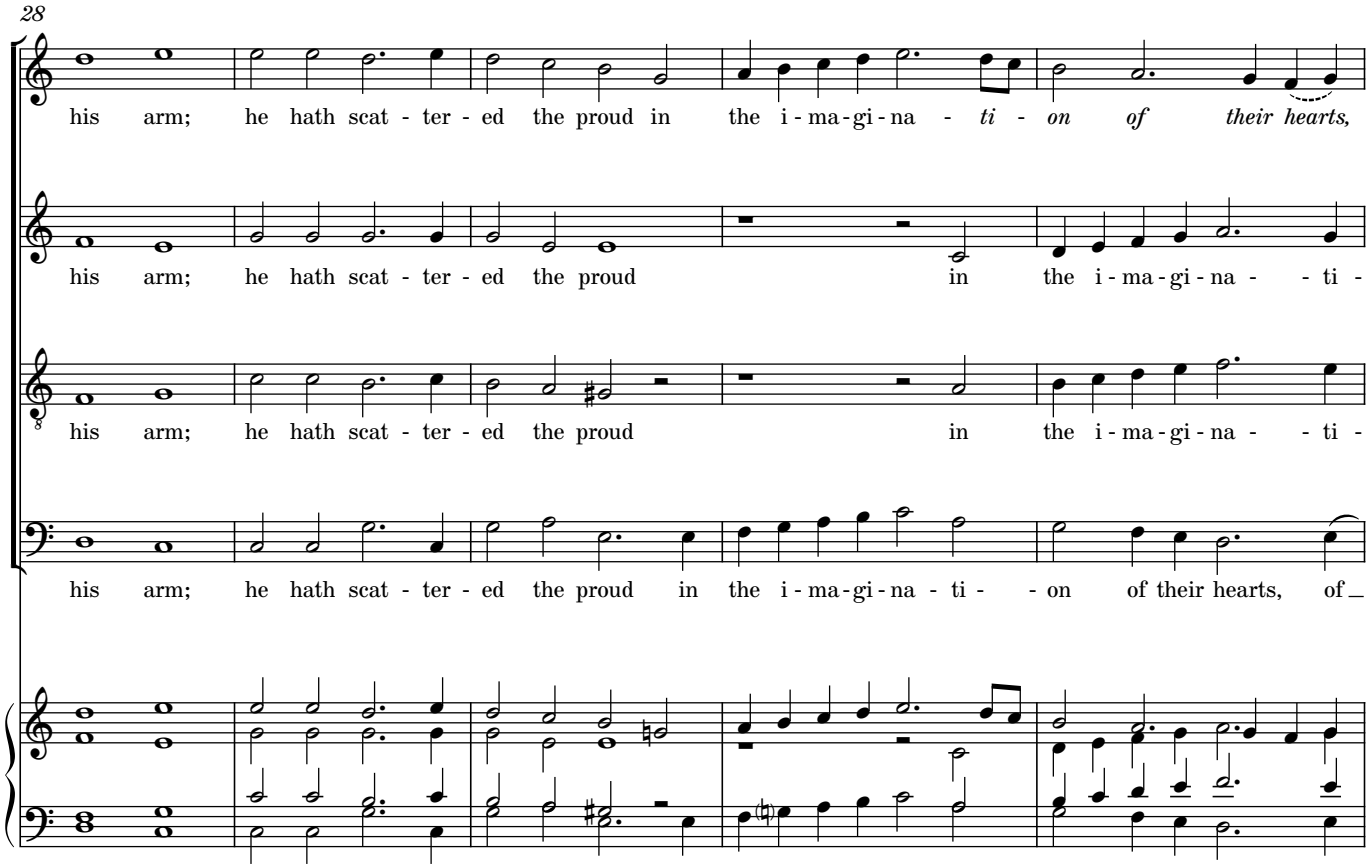


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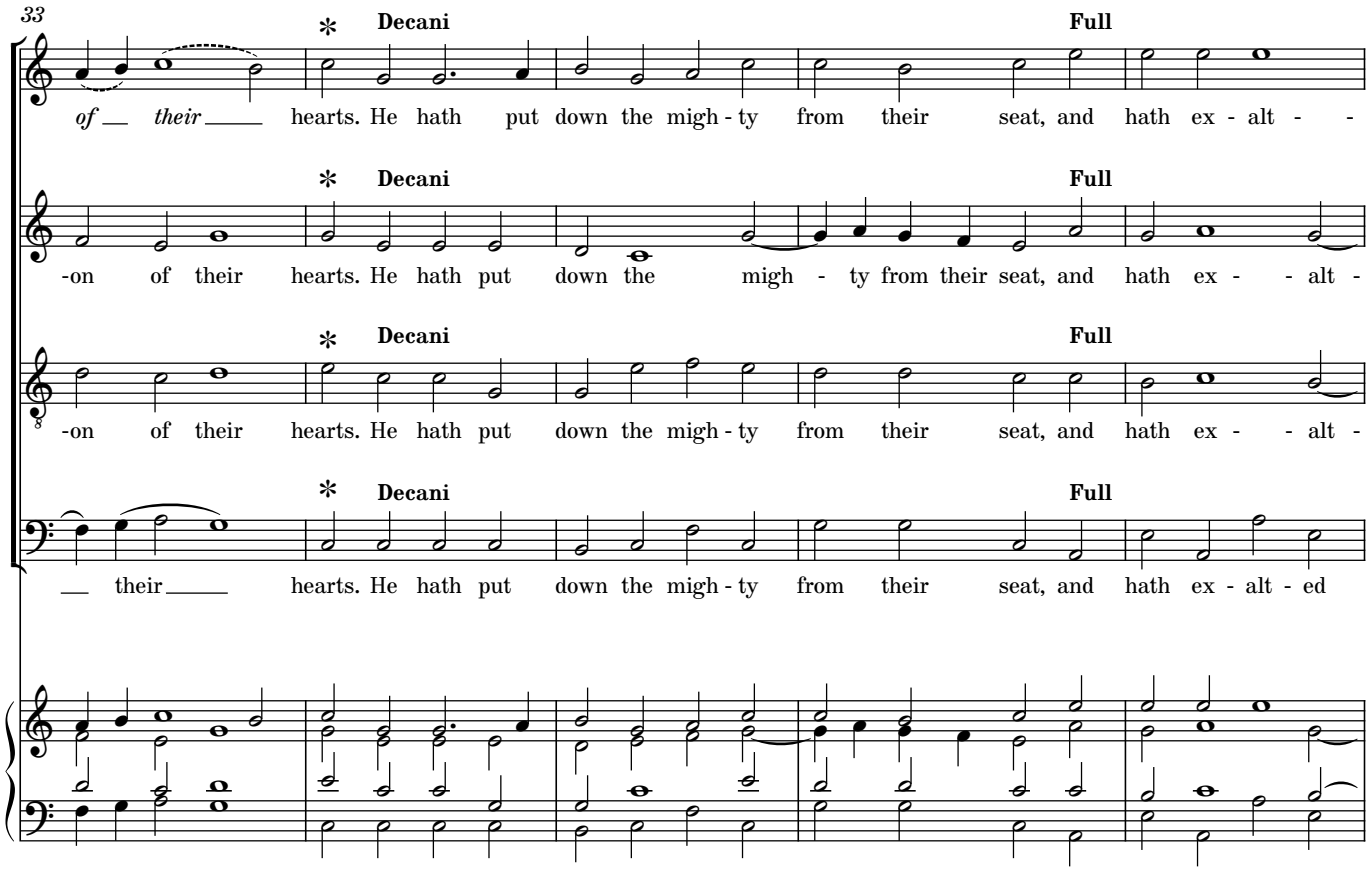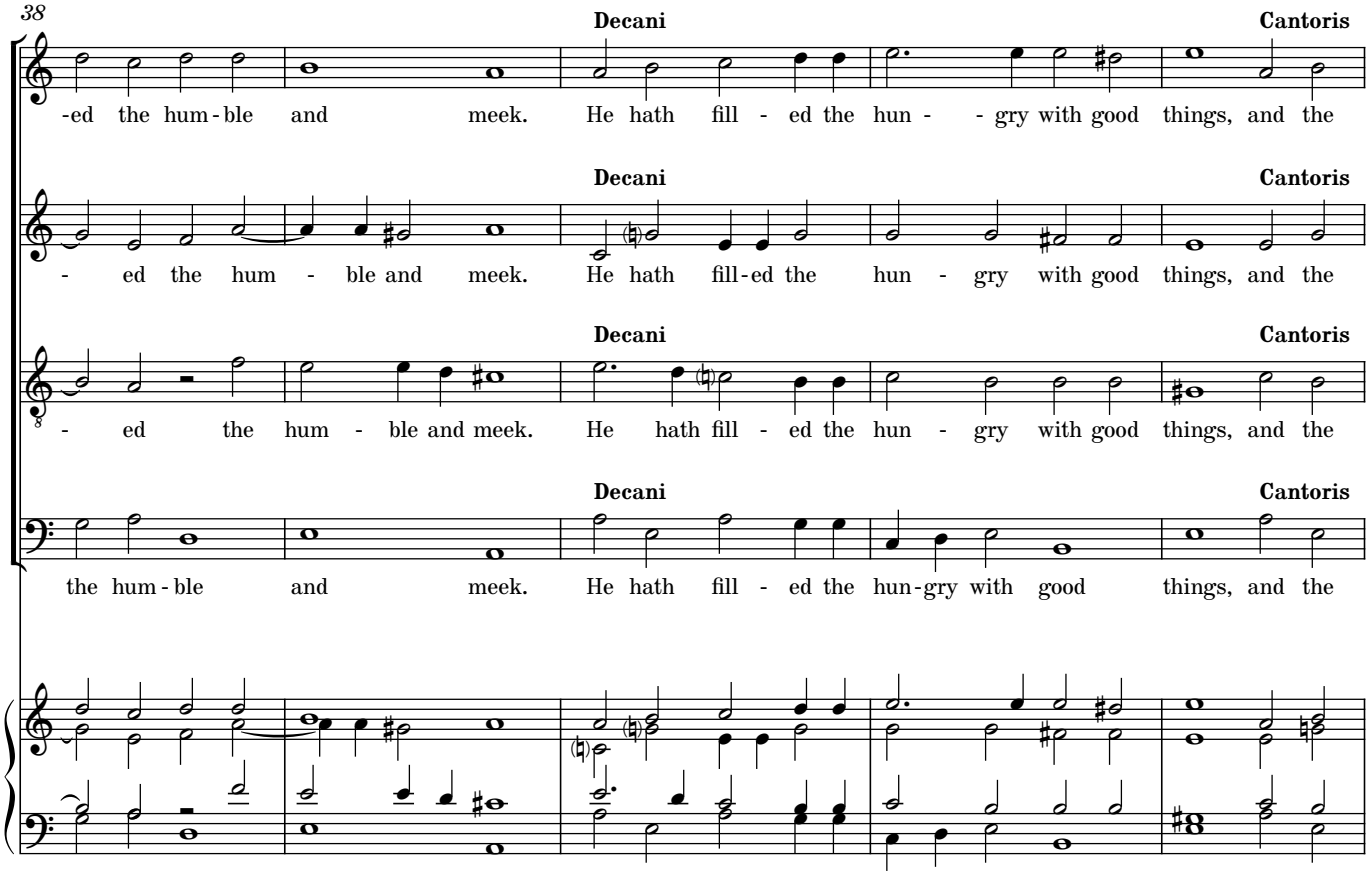


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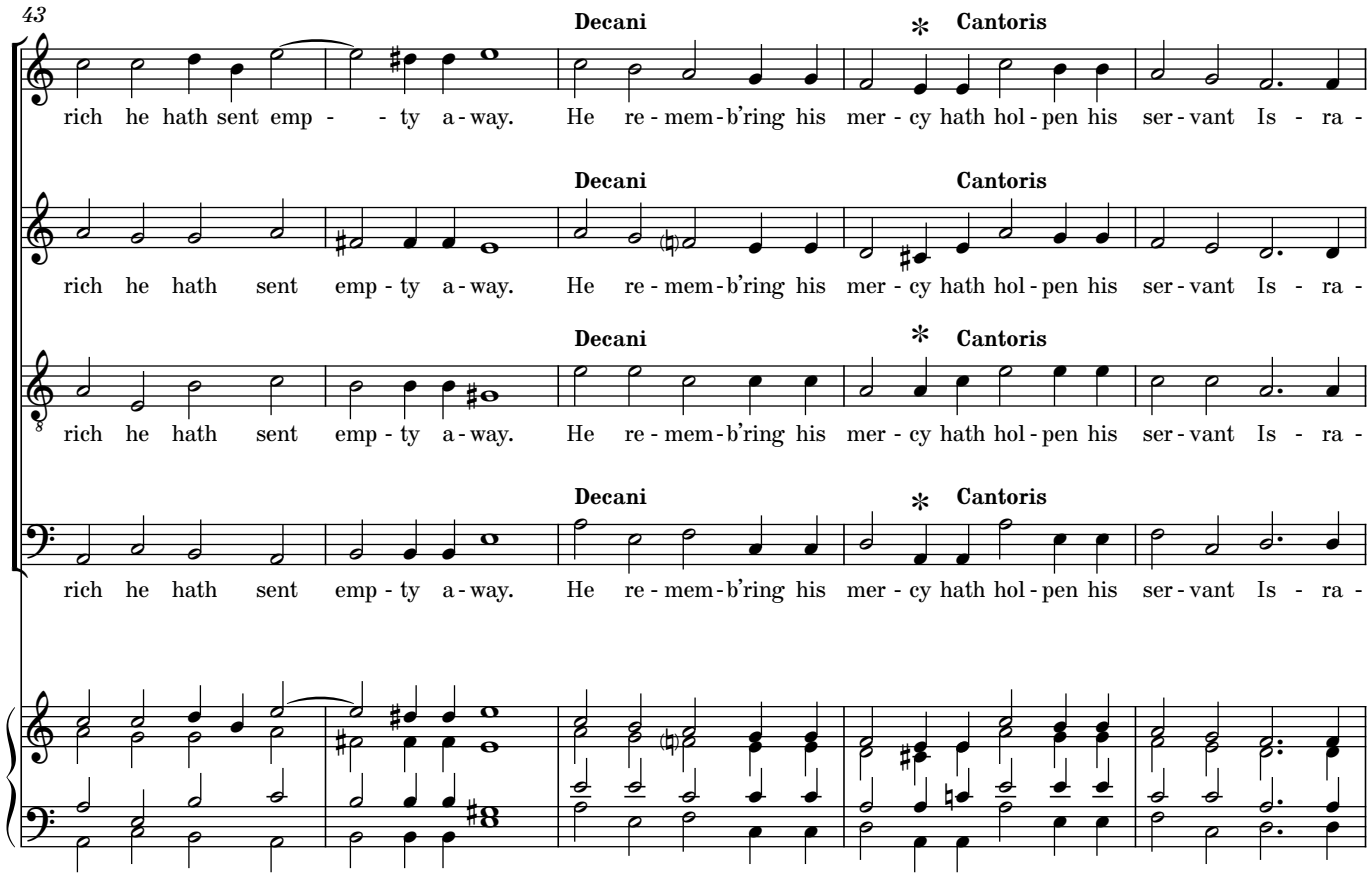


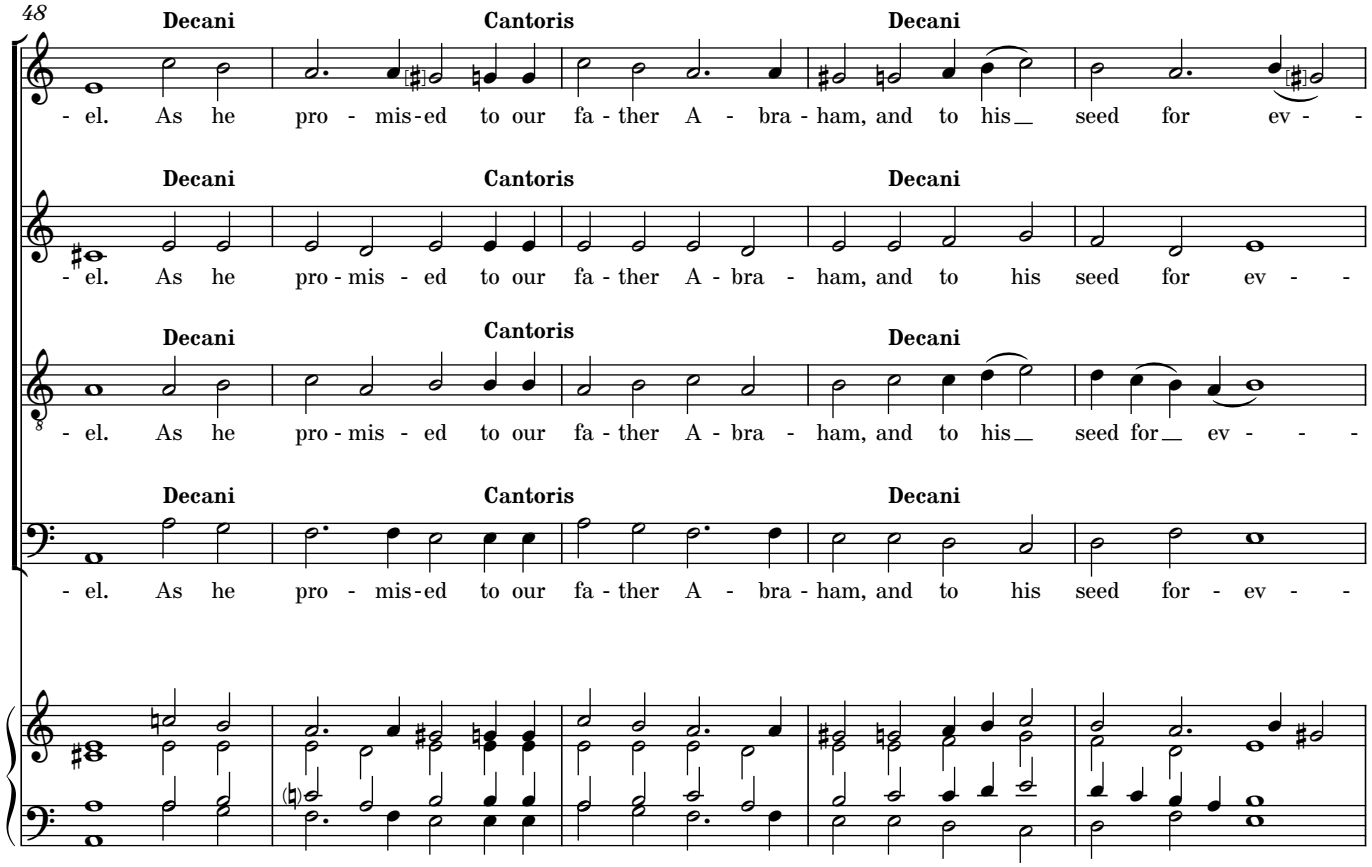
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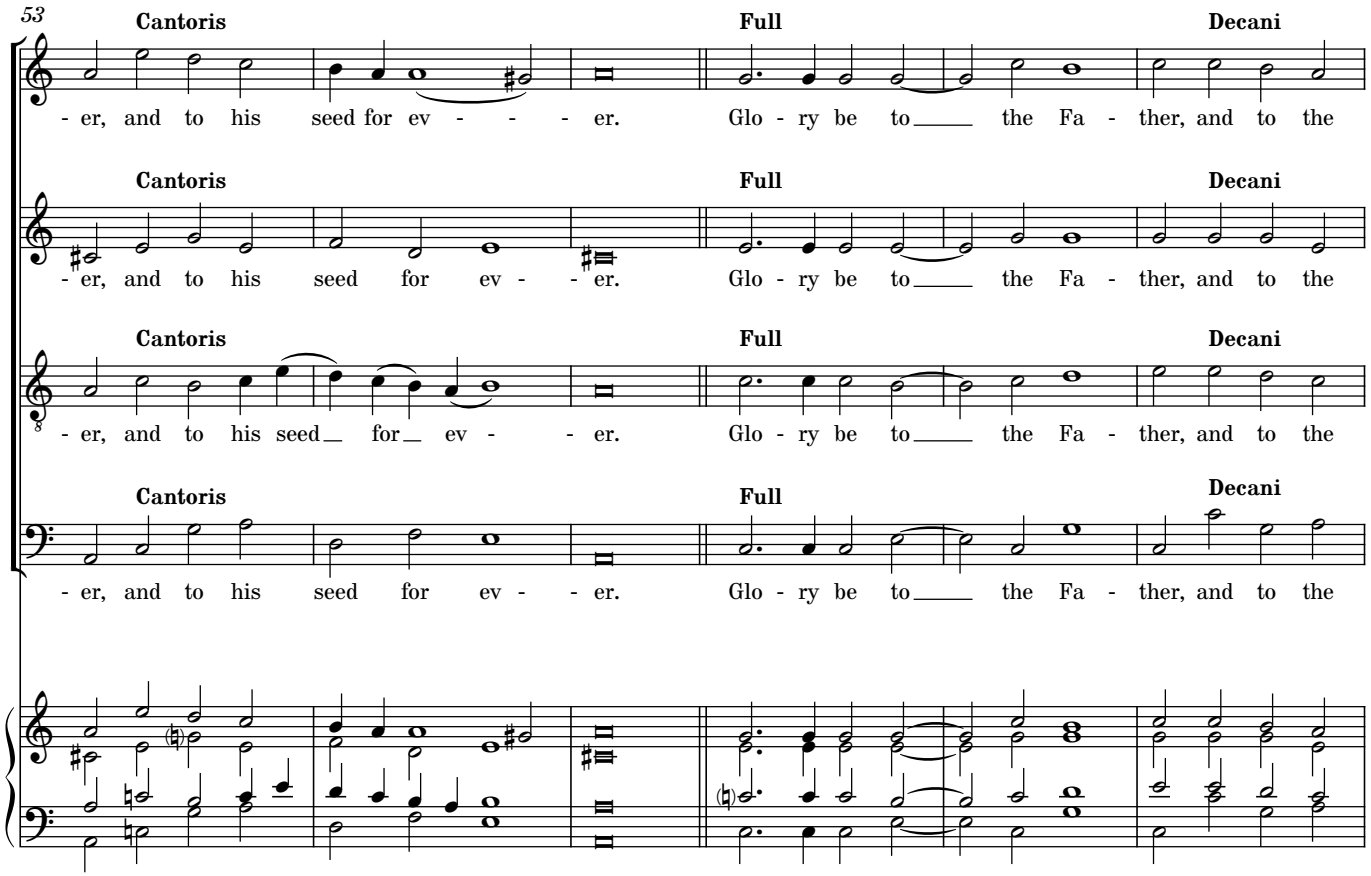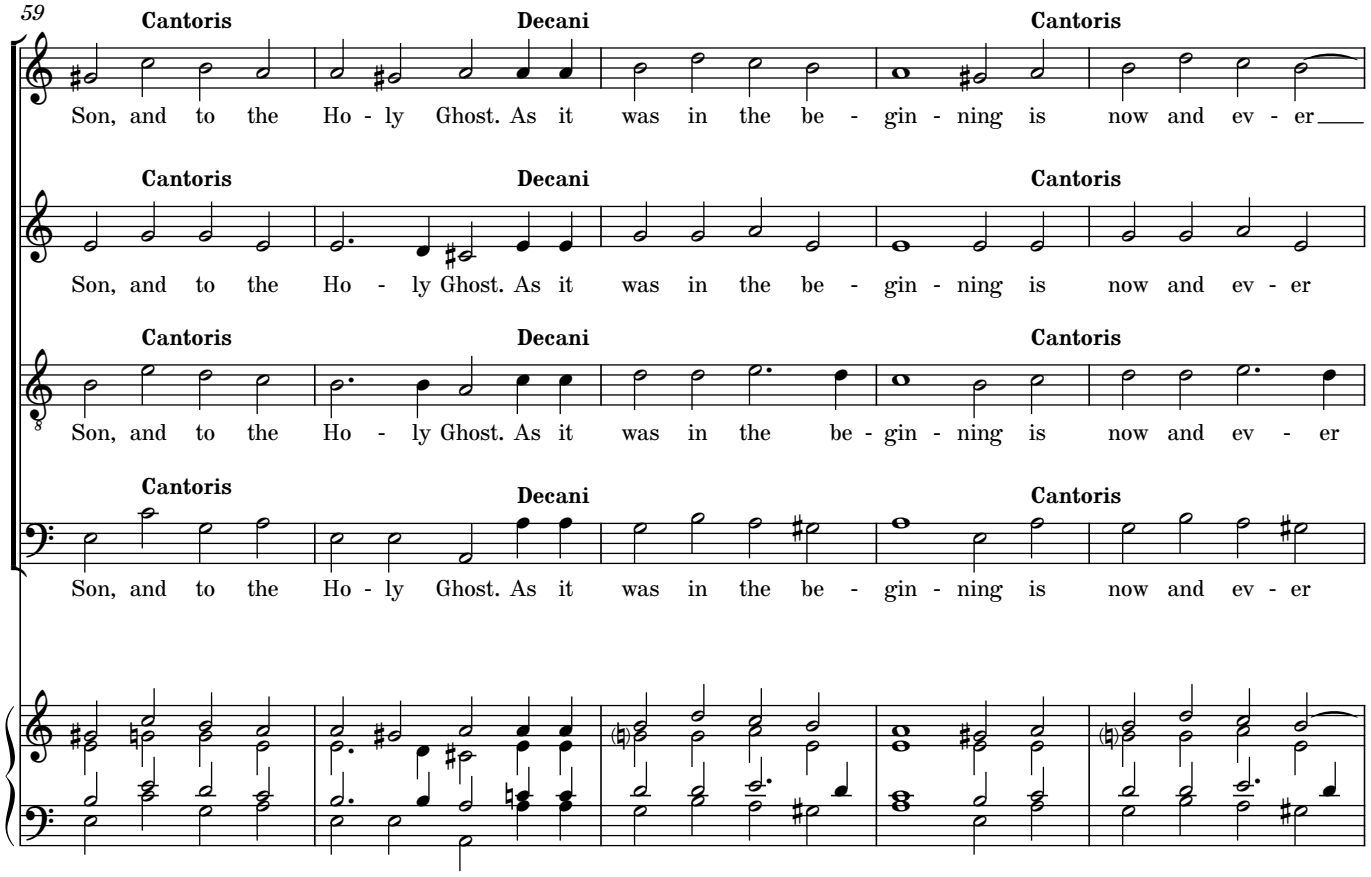


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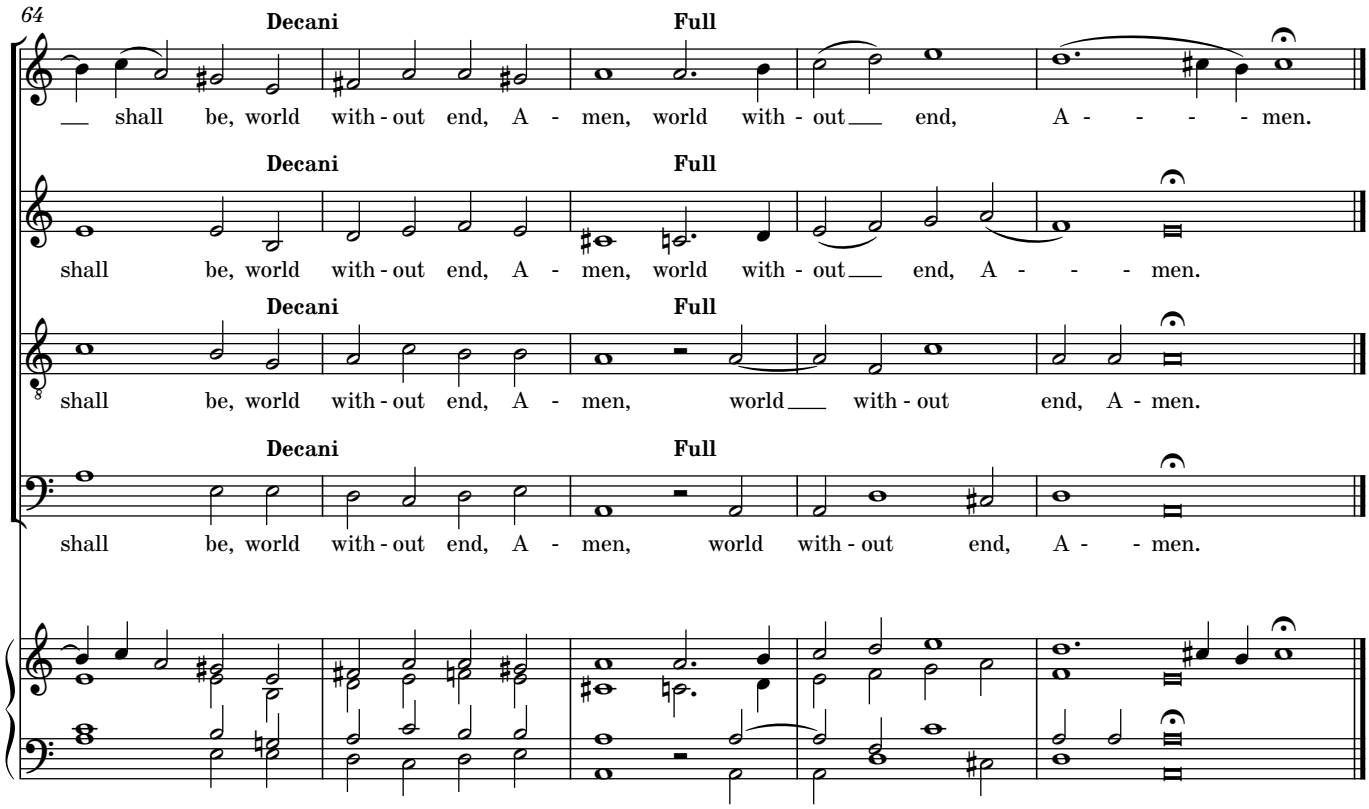


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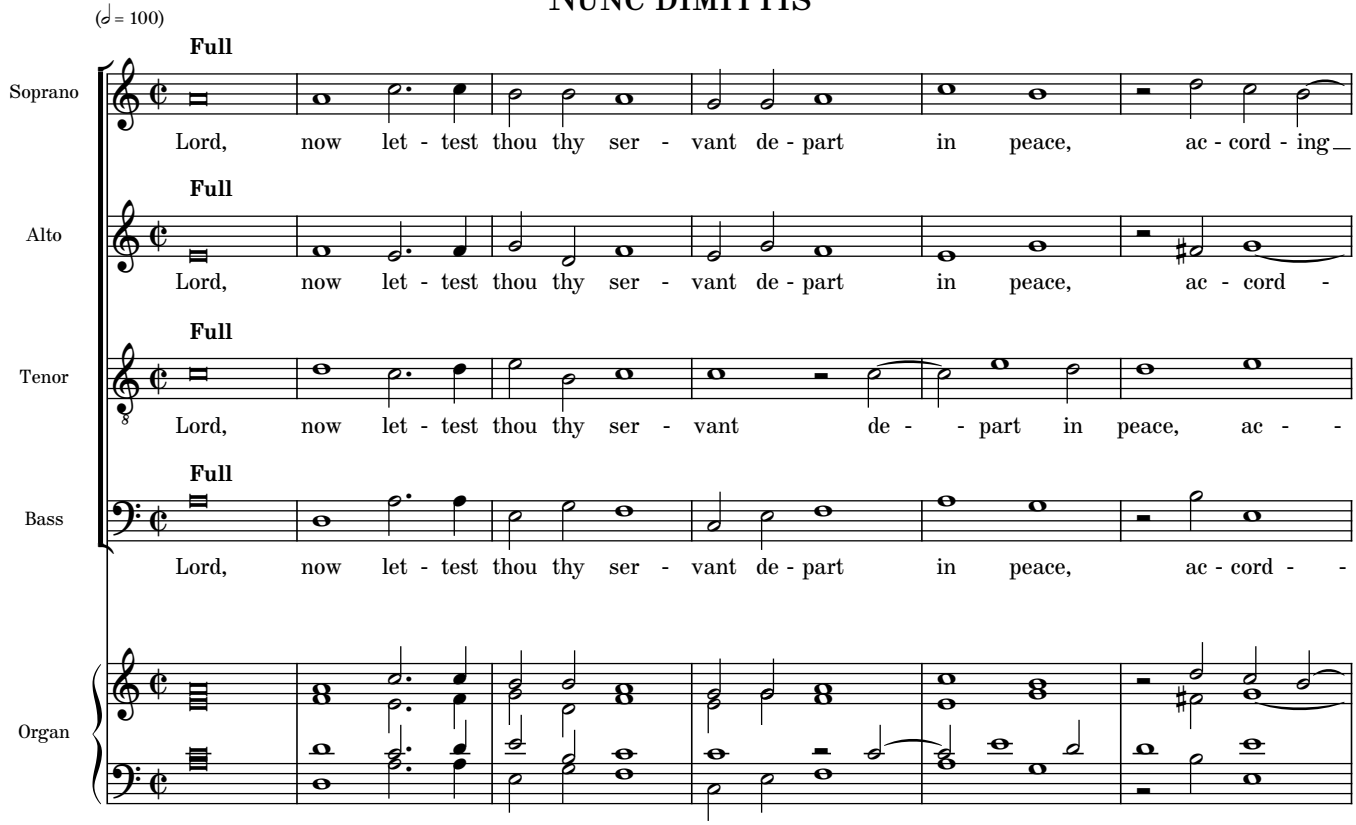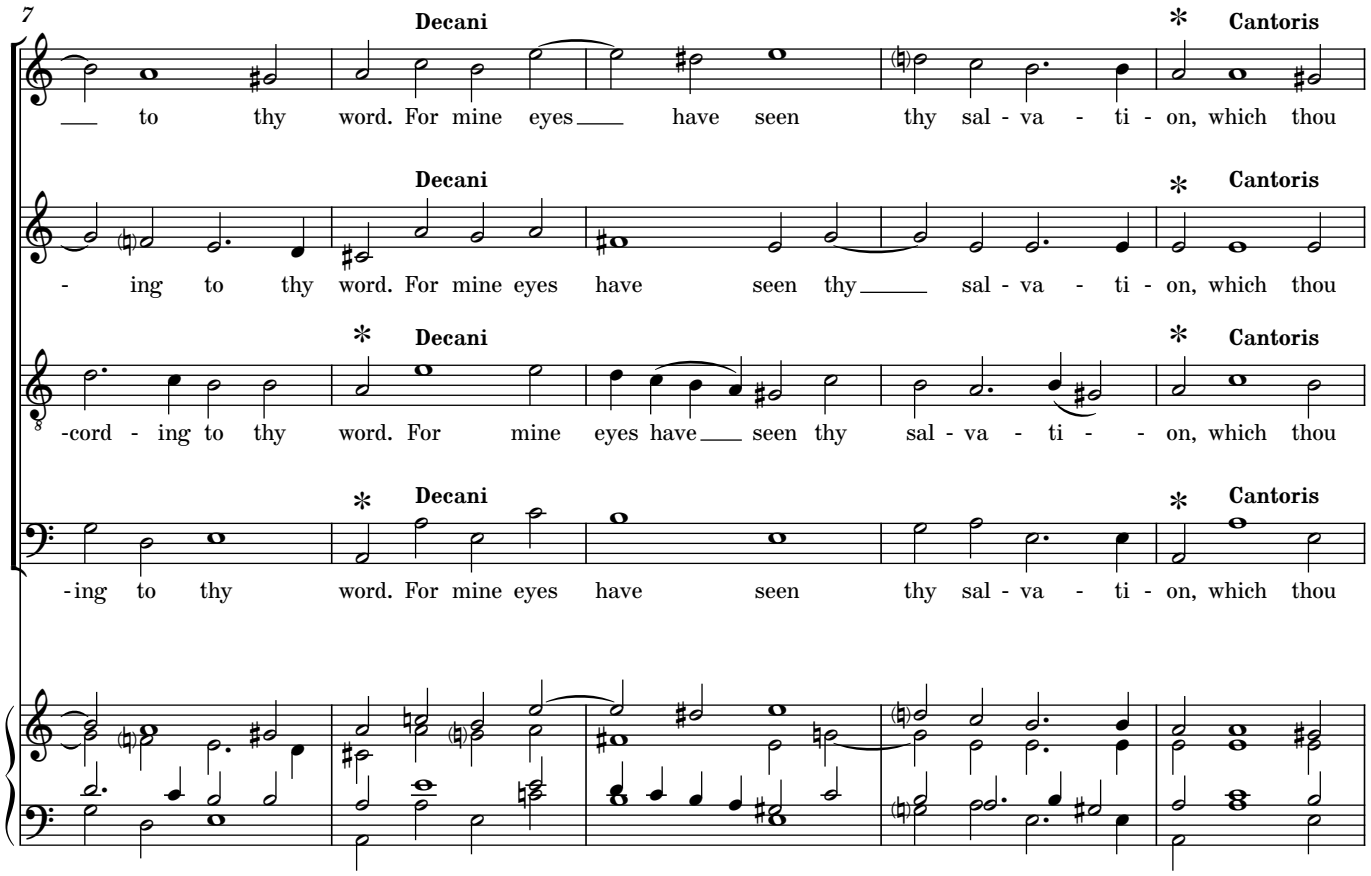




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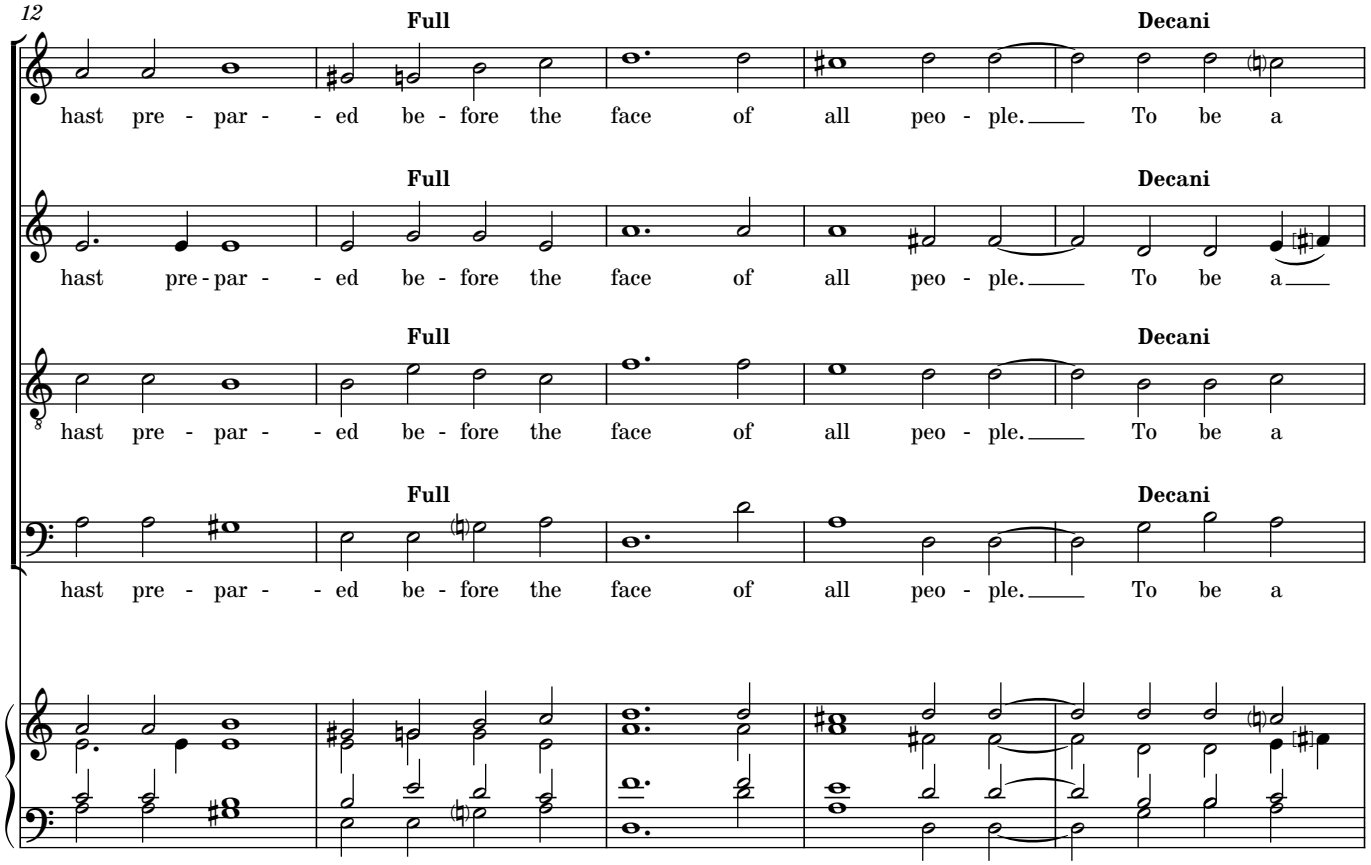


NUNC DIMITTIS

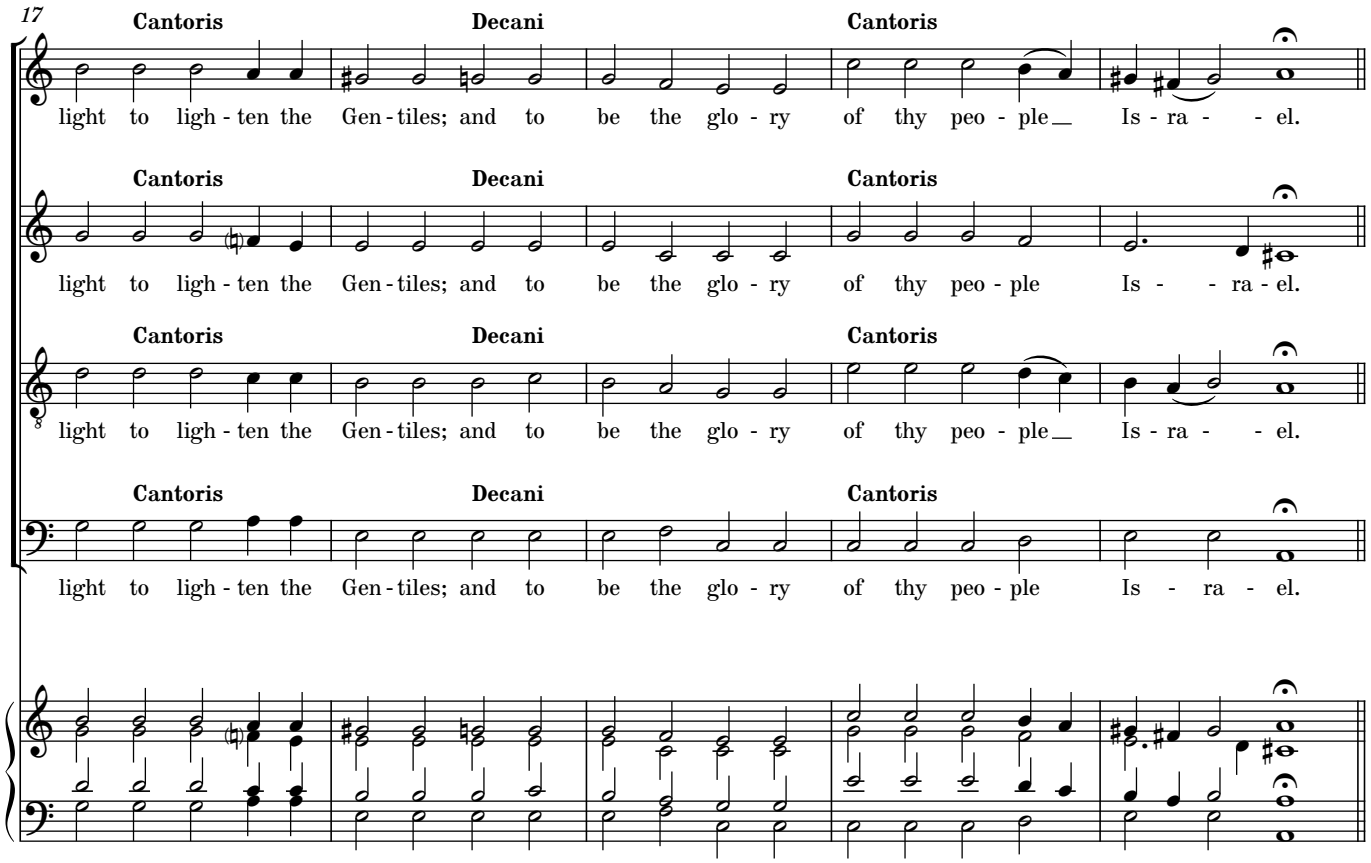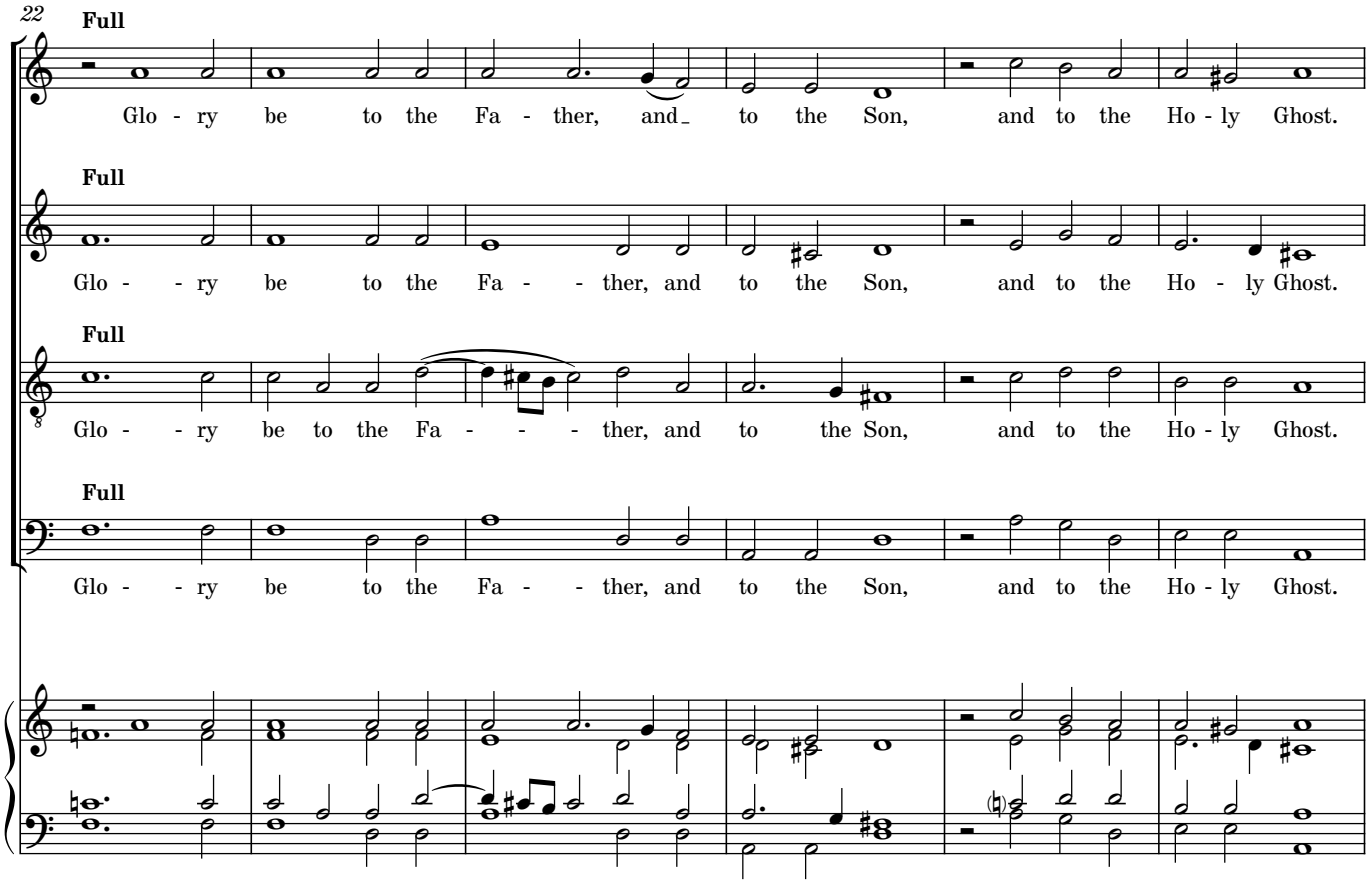


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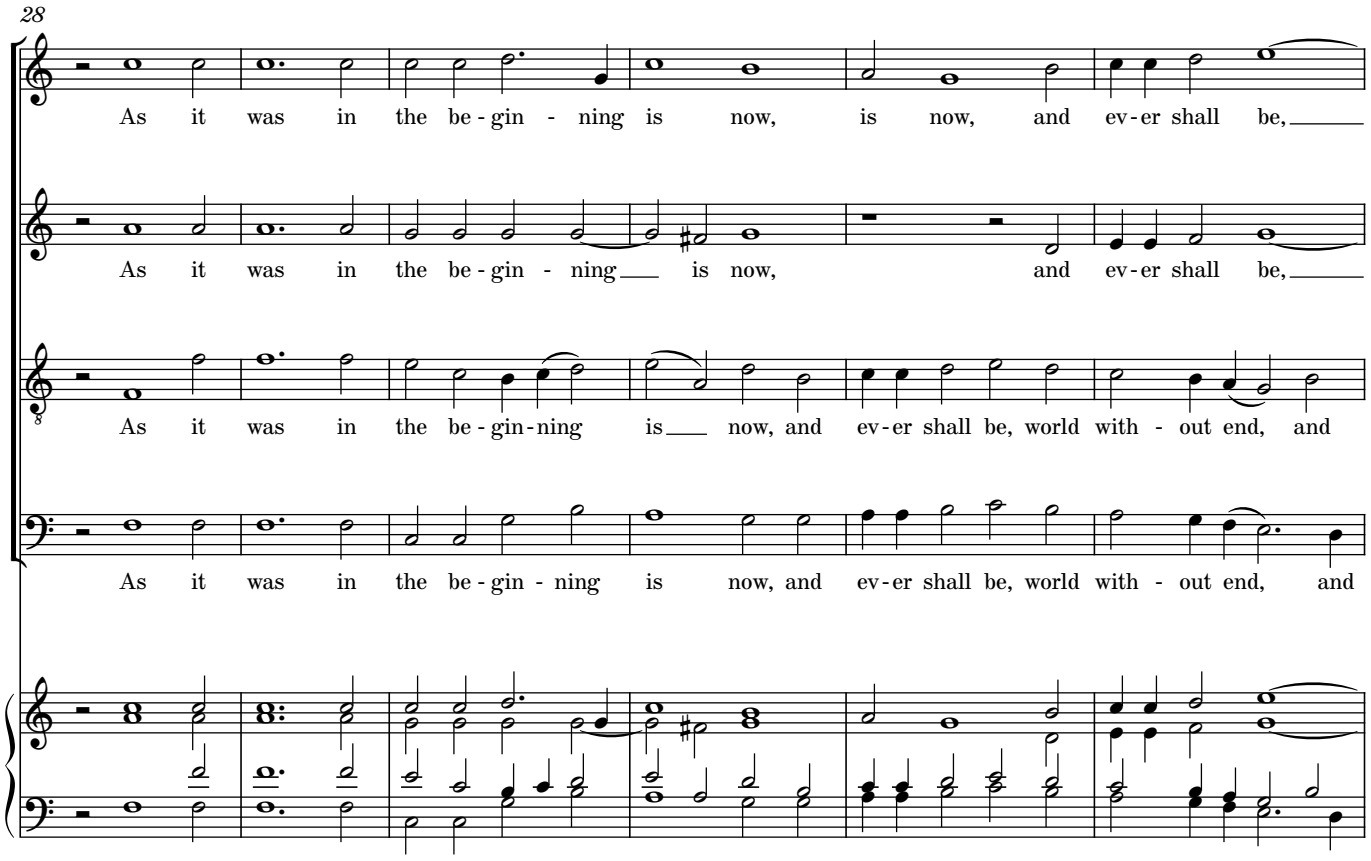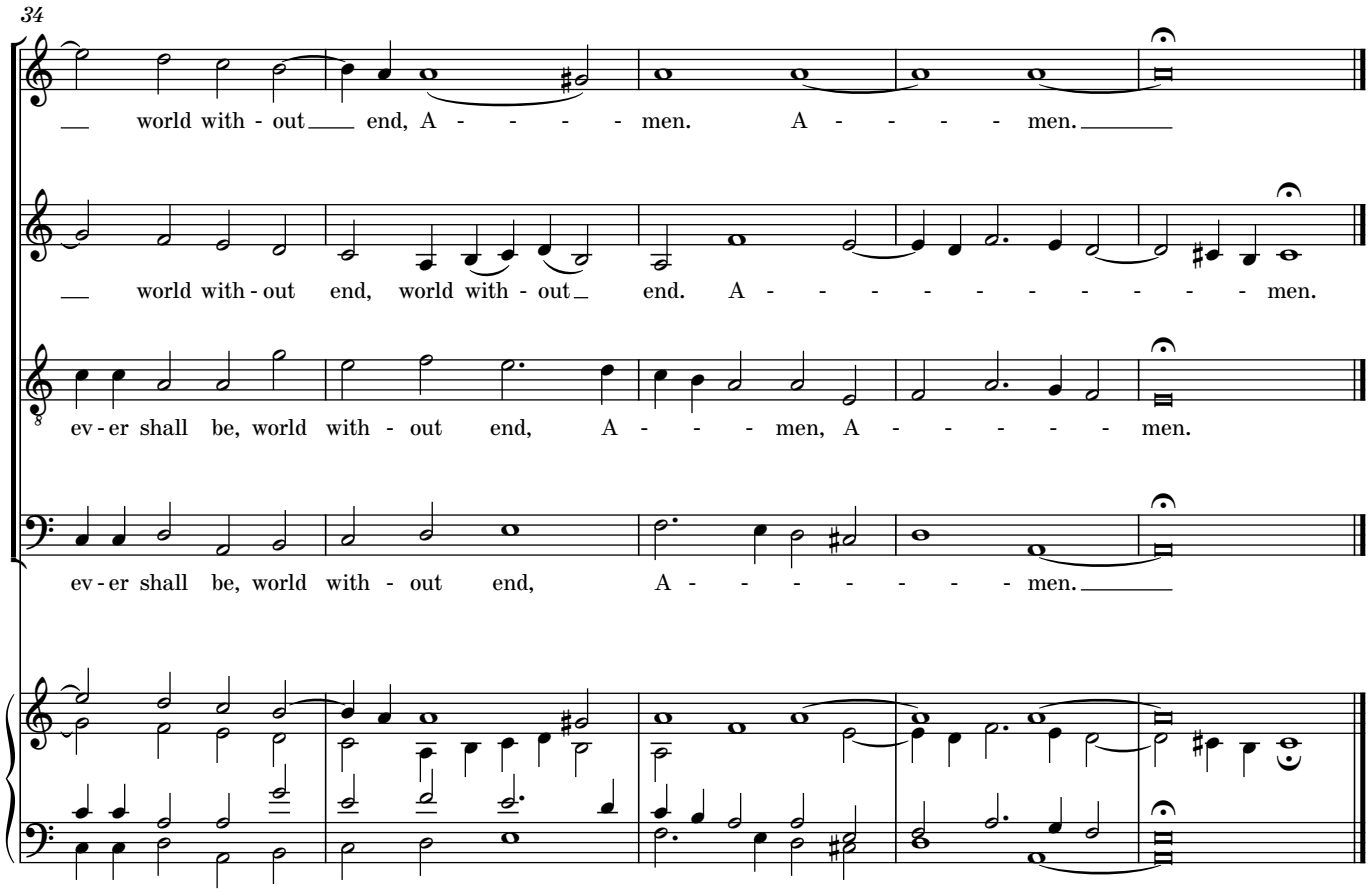


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ANCIENT GROOVE MUSIC

EDITORIAL NOTES

'High' Evening Service
Richard Farrant

Sources:
Cambridge: Peterhouse, Latter Caroline Set MS 36, 37, 42, 45, 44
Oxford: Christ Church Mus. 1220 – 1224

The music is presented at original pitch and note values. Barlines and fermatas are editorial. Accidentals in square brackets are editorial additions; those in parentheses are cautionary.

The surviving sources for this music describe the work variously with the names 'High', 'Third', 'Short' and 'Full Service for Meanes'. There is a Short Service by John Farrant (whose relationship to Richard is uncertainly, but likely related): this name as therefore been avoided. This service appears in Boyce's *Cathedral Music* (1760), transposed down to G minor, and 'tidied up' considerably, robbing it of its delicious false relations and discords. The name 'High' seems to describe the vocal range well, and it fits modern voice types well without need for transposition.

Asterisks * above notes indicate places in antiphonal sections where the 'out-going' choir holds their note over the first note of the in-coming choir. These are clearly marked in the partbooks, and was a common practice of the period, though is usually ignored in modern editions (largely because of the engraving practicalities of scoring different durations for two parts on the same pitch clearly). Any 'bumping' or hiatus at the change-over points should be avoided.

The work may be performed with or without organ accompaniment.

Magnificat
b. 31: The underlay is poorly defined in the sources, and alternatives may be found.

Nunc dimittis
b. 21: The final note is a breve in all sources.

Minor variations between the sources are not listed.

This gem of music for the early Protestant liturgy has been sadly neglected since Fellowes' edition of the 1930s. Most recent public domain editions copy the version 'damaged' by Boyce.

Ben Byram-Wigfield
London, 2024